India hosted the 2019 BIMSTEC Summit at Vishakapatnam (7 November–8 November, 2019). This was the first BIMSTEC Conclave of Ports. This can be read as India's boost to its Act-East Policy as well as countries like Thailand and others Look-West Policy. SAARC falling out of gear this forum can help India to enhance its outreach cooperation to counter China with a strong bond with the BIMSTEC countries.

The recent passage of the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 in December 2019 amended the earlier Citizenship Act of 1955. It contains provisions for acquiring citizenship for Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi and Christian religious minorities who are fleeing persecution from three countries, namely, Pakistan, Bangladesh and Afghanistan.

It is to be seen how these pro-active engagements are beneficial for India and what dividends it can bring for India.